very little effect. The press releases from the Indian High Commission denying the existence of smuggling had less and less credibility with the Bangladesh people. It lowered the prestige of Indian High Commissioner and his colleagues. It is true that it is not possible to stop smuggling effectively on such a long border as India has with Bangladesh. But the smugglers in league with the administration and politicians on both sides of the border played havoc with the Bangladesh economy. This not only had an adverse economic effect but also politically had a very unhealthy impact in Bangladesh. The lure of easy money corrupted an important section of the leadership of the Awami League and blackened its image in the popular mind. When the State Trading Corporation of India (STCI) took over the responsibility of sending dhotis and sa-rees to Bangladesh that created even greater scandal because they sent a large quantity of utterly rejected material.

This came as a shock to the common man in Bangladesh.

The most important failure of Indian diplomacy in Bangladesh, however, was its indifference to and neglect of the country's pro-Indian elements. This, the Indian diplomats argued, was because there was no such pro-Indian core in Bangladesh. But the report which at times was brutally honest, said:

This would be a wrong statement. We can say from our own experience that for diverse reasons—political, economic, cultural and also sentimental— there are large sections of the people in Bangladesh who would like to develop the closest and friendliest of relations between the two countries. The Indian diplomacy allowed this hardcore to disintegrate from sheer indifference. Soon, a feeling spread that India was not interested in them. This proved utterly ruinous because when